

Coaching is a structured, purposeful, and collaborative development process in which an experienced individual (the coach) supports a learner or client (the coachee) in achieving specific personal or professional goals. Rather than directly instructing or teaching, a coach unlocks a person's potential to maximize their own performance. It is a forward-focused, action-oriented partnership designed to foster self-awareness, improve capabilities, and facilitate lasting change.

Core Components of Coaching

Coaching is built on several foundational elements that distinguish it from mentoring, consulting, or therapy:

- **Partnership of Equals:** The coach and coachee work together on equal footing. The coach is an expert in the *process* of coaching, while the coachee is acknowledged as the expert on their own life or professional challenges.
- **Goal-Centered Approach:** Coaching is defined by specific goals and desired outcomes. It involves setting clear targets, exploring current realities, identifying options, and taking action.
- **Powerful Questioning:** Coaches rarely give advice or direct solutions. Instead, they use powerful questions and active listening to help the coachee discover their own answers, thereby building self-confidence and self-reliance.